

THERMACART · DESIGN DECISIONS REGISTER

ThermaCart design decisions register

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DOCUMENT CONTROL

Document ID	TCT-DEC-001	Version	0.2
Status	Draft	Date	2026-10-02
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Project TRL	TRL 3 Proof of concept		
Repository	github.com/BoujeeEnjinia1701/thermacart		
Source	docs/06-design-decisions.md @ uncommitted		

REVISION HISTORY

Version	Date	Author	Change
0.2	2026-10-02	Amish Chadha	Amish approved the recommendations for all nine open decisions on 2026-10-02 (TCT-DDR-003 Table 3 accepted, A1 as option (b)); moved to decisions made
0.1	2026-10-01	Amish Chadha	Register opened with the open decisions from the review note, the decision records and the build plan work; budget treated as a value-engineering target

ThermaCart design decisions register

Every design decision still to be made, and every decision made, in one place. Each decision is argued in full in its decision record under `docs/decisions/`; this register is the index Amish works from. The build plan (`docs/05-build-plan.md`) describes the design as it stands and does not list open decisions.

■ Open decisions

None. All open decisions were decided on 2026-10-02.

■ To confirm when parts are bought

#	What to confirm	Why it matters	Source
1	The tube's outside and inside corner radii (3/16 and 1/16 in assumed) and its actual bore at both ends	The spacer and plug are cut to the bore and their corners follow the inside radius; the O-ring squeeze depends on it	TCT-DDR-003, P2, P11; REVIEW.md 2026-09-26, item 5
2	FKM O-ring cord 2.5 mm is stocked, and the splicing method (cyanoacrylate splice or a vulcanised ring) for a 361 mm loop	The gland is sized for 2.5 mm cord	TCT-DDR-003, P2
3	M5 FKM bonded sealing washers fit the button-head screws' heads	They seal the radial screw holes	TCT-DDR-003, P3
4	A G 1/2 anodised aluminium plug with collar and a matching FKM bonded seal	The fill port seal and the R5 mass both assume it	TCT-DDR-003, P1
5	The structural epoxy is rated to 120 °C or more and is listed as resistant to paraffins	It bonds the fins, the cap stacks and the indicator, and seals the stack joints	TCT-PRC-001; TCT-DDR-003, P4
6	The clear polycarbonate tube grade is rated above 90 °C and stays clear with the H70 paraffin	The H70 indicator sits on a cartridge at up to 90 °C	TCT-DDR-003, P9
7	The high-temperature paint is rated well above 90 °C, and its curing temperature	The finish (O8); some paints need an oven cure that must not reach a filled cartridge	TCT-DDR-002, O8
8	Phenolic (paper or cotton laminate) sheet 3 mm for the washers	The thermal break is sized on phenolic's conductivity	TCT-CAL-001, F1
9	Supplier quotes for every BOM line	All prices are indicative	TCT-DDR-002, O6

■ Value engineering

Value-engineering target: USD 80 for one C5 cartridge and one adapter frame (a hypothetical control target, not a limit; Amish, 2026-10-01). Estimated cost of the constructable design: USD 97 (USD 17 over the target): the cartridge USD 80 against its USD 50 target in R16, and the frame USD 17 against its USD 20 target. Main cost drivers and savings worth trying:

- The largest lines are the shell (tube, fin bar and paint, USD 29), the two cap stacks (USD 14), the frame (USD 17), the PCM (USD 11 at USD 10/kg for the first build) and the hardware (USD 11).

- Making the design constructable added USD 5 to the cartridge (bonded seals, bolts, phenolic washers) and USD 1 to the frame (rivets), less USD 1 for the smaller fill plug.
- Savings worth trying: buy tube, plate and fin bar for a batch of cartridges (offcuts and cut-to-length charges dominate a one-off); stainless hardware from a bulk supplier rather than a hardware store; paint several cartridges from one set of aerosol cans; a frame without side walls where the host already guides the cartridge; quotes for PCM in 10 kg lots. Dropping the fins (about USD 8) would cost hold and charge time (R10, R12) and is not recommended.

■ Decisions made

Date	Decision	Decided by	Record
2026-09-25	D1 to D8: GN 1/3 envelope from a stock tube; C5, C25 and H70 paraffins with W0 as an option, C5 first; pitch "cold chain, comfort and hot holding"; grade keying and a passive indicator; 2 mm wall not used; one C5 cartridge and one frame for the prototype; produce cooler as first host type; fill hot and seal for life in aluminium	Amish: "i accept all your recommendations, go with them across all repos."	TCT-DDR-001, TCT-DDR-002
2026-09-25	T1 to T4: folding bail on a thermal break, cap stack from plate, stock fin bar, 85 °C oven limit	Amish, same instruction	TCT-DDR-001, TCT-DDR-002
2026-09-25	O4 to O9: R5 38 % for the stock tube; dark finish and produce on the cartridges for R10; quotes before any cost change; H70 oven handling rule; matte black finish; C25 band 22 to 27 °C	Amish, same instruction	TCT-DDR-002
2026-09-30	Make the design physically buildable while drawing the build plan: changes P1 to P11 (fill port, O-ring gland, sealed radial screws, bonded cap stack, bolted lug angles and bail, key tab fixing, frame stop, frame corners, melt indicator, fin bond, tube radii), made under this instruction; Table 3 accepted on 2026-10-02 (below)	Amish: "If you are realising that the design cannot be built as per concept - fix the design assumptions to match and be physically feasible as you draw the illustrations."	TCT-DDR-003
2026-09-30	Outstanding decisions are kept in this register, not in the build plan	Amish: "don't log outstanding decisions in this build plan - that is not the place for it."	This register
2026-10-01	budget_usd is a hypothetical value-engineering target, not a spending limit; cost requirements are reported against it	Amish: "the budgets are a hypothetical control target to ensure we are thinking along a value engineering lens."	TCT-CAL-001 v0.3, section H
2026-10-02	Wrong grade (R9): option (b). A low lip at the frame's open end is designed on paper now, with the stowed grip moved up to suit, so the frame physically rejects a wrong grade instead of leaving it 12 mm proud; fall back to (a) only if the TRL 4 check shows that no target host's lid can close on a proud cartridge	Amish: "i approve your recommendations for all 555 open decisions."	TCT-DDR-003, A1
2026-10-02	W0 key: when W0 is sized, its key tab is fixed with screws 4 mm each side of its centre and that frame's corner tab is shortened; the published key table is unchanged	Amish: "i approve your recommendations for all 555 open decisions."	TCT-DDR-003, A2
2026-10-02	R5 margin of 0.1 percentage point accepted; a filled prototype is weighed at TRL 4, and if it misses, the tubular bail rod is the first saving	Amish: "i approve your recommendations for all 555 open decisions."	TCT-DDR-003, A3
2026-10-02	First host: a produce cooler user reached through a postharvest extension partner. First candidate to approach: the UC Davis Postharvest Technology Center, asked to introduce a grower group or market	Amish: "i approve your recommendations for all 555 open decisions."	TCT-DDR-001, O1

Date	Decision	Decided by	Record
	cooler operator that already uses passive or ice-based cooling		
2026-10-02	Neither ColdPod nor ZeerBox declares ThermaCart as a dependency now; neither has a GN 1/3 slot, and the first host is the produce cooler of item 4	Amish: "i approve your recommendations for all 555 open decisions."	TCT-DDR-001, O2
2026-10-02	C5 is charged in a domestic freezer followed by the conditioning step (about 4.2 h), and the conditioning time is printed on the C5 label as a required step	Amish: "i approve your recommendations for all 555 open decisions."	TCT-DDR-001, O3
2026-10-02	Grade colour band: an 18 mm painted band round the nose end, a masking step in BOM line 1	Amish: "i approve your recommendations for all 555 open decisions."	REVIEW.md, 2026-09-26, item 1
2026-10-02	Painted side marking "ThermaCart, TC-L C5" adopted as part of the label set (BOM line 6)	Amish: "i approve your recommendations for all 555 open decisions."	REVIEW.md, 2026-09-26, item 2
2026-10-02	"C5 ONLY" frame decal adopted; rubber feet are left to each host	Amish: "i approve your recommendations for all 555 open decisions."	REVIEW.md, 2026-09-26, item 3